

BERNERA NEWS

By the community, for the community
in association with **The Daily Ceilidh**

Welcome to issue 29 of the Bernera News. It's strange to think that only 3 years ago we started the new year with no real understanding of just how much our lives would change due to the pandemic. It showed us that even though we may be able to anticipate a situation arising, we can't know how we, or indeed others around us, will react and how our lives will change.

After such situations it is easy to focus on the negatives, and we often over look, and soon forget about, the positives: The way that people helped each other even more than usual; the extra time that families had to spend together; and the way so many of us embraced "new" technology to spend virtual time with family and friends, to name but a few.

With the current economic difficulties faced by so many it is easy for us to get caught up in our own lives and perhaps to forget that others too may be struggling. It is heartening to see so much going on within our communities to help during this time. It must, however, also be remembered that we can all play our own part individually. If we no longer have use for an item it could still make a difference to someone else's life, be that a warm jumper or a good book.

If we're running to the shop we could offer to pick something up for a neighbour or friend so they don't have to also use fuel to get there. Ultimately we need to remember, it costs nothing to be kind.

KUNE KUNE PIGLETS FOR SALE



Gorgeous Kune Kune Pigs seeking new homes. Located in Breaclete, Bernera.

Their parents are pedigree Kune Kune and they are all birth notified, tagged and wormed.

They will make great growers or pets. Belly rubs are optional.

Contact Andrea on **07952 651457**

CLEANER FOR HOLIDAY HOMES ON BERNERA

Are you looking for an extra bit of income this season? Do you have Saturdays free? How does being a valuable part of a local holiday home cleaning team sound?

If you have 3-6 hours free between 10am and 4pm, are meticulous in your attention to detail and would like to earn a great rate of pay, then this might just be the opportunity you are looking for.

Saturday cleaners sought for the season from March to October to clean 2, locally owned holiday lets. Please phone Julia, in the first instance on **07894 516 609** and she will chat you through the job and it's pay etc.

SEW BERNERA



The Sew Bernera group got off to a festive start just in time for the making of some Christmas presents (stockings).

The first session for 2023 saw the group starting to make a sewing roll which can be used to put pins, scissors and tape measures in.

We meet every **Thursday from 6.30-8.30pm** in the small room at the back of the Bernera Community Hall and welcome any level of sewer. Or, those who want a chat while watching others sew!

We started meeting in response to a request for **'anyone out there who can sew to please show me how'**.

Julia and Virginia answered the call and gathered their sewing machines, overlockers and sewing gear to get the group going. Everyone who turned up to the first meeting agreed that they wanted to learn (or dust off) basic sewing skills which may end up morphing into couturier results ...or may result in them sewing on a loose button or hemming a pair of trousers.



A shout out to the community – if anyone has any fabric, thread, buttons, etc. they don't need any more or a sewing machine they don't want, please let us know.

It's not too late to come along to the group. If you can't come every week, that's OK too. Sew at your own pace. Contact Virginia (07460 467 721) or Julia (07894 516 609) to find out more.



Virginia Allum
Earshader



THURSDAY SOUP STOP

The Bernera Trust and Association started the first 'Thursday Soup Stop' on the 12th January and it was lovely to see folk head out despite the rainy weather!

The Soup Stop provides another warm place to meet, chat and enjoy a delicious bowl of soup & bread, hot drinks and biscuits (all free of charge).



Each week there will be two soups, a vegetarian and gluten free one and non-vegetarian (also gluten free biscuits & oat milk for those with sensitivities). Everyone's welcome and we look forward to seeing you there.

Free lift service for those without transport
(call **07771 534 048** or email **jo@greatbernera.org** to arrange in advance)



PENNY'S PLANTINGS

January the 12th. Goodness me! Already! What does this date remind me of, I can't remember... Some celebration coming up, about a poet and some Haggis... answers on a postcard.

My head is full of ideas for the garden, what to put in that bare patch which has suddenly appeared after constant rain. A mud bath to be sure. Too late for spring bulbs. An excuse to wander round a garden centre .

If you haven't made it out to look at the bare bones of your garden, do so now. As time will fast flow into spring. If you have some bush or tree that needs cutting back, get on with it before the sap starts to rise, and who knows how early that is going to happen? (The exception being Buddlias cut these down in March for a full bush of flowers.) Usually I would say end of March, but who knows now?

January is a month for planning 2023's garden, what seeds to grow and when? It's never that clear is it? Will your excitement overthrow your common sense? The only seeds I'm planting this month are my Sweet Pea seeds. I've been soaking them for a couple of weeks now, waiting for that first shoot to appear. Fascinating things Sweet Peas, I grow mine in old toilet roll innards, ideal for long roots. Sweet peas will flower from May to the first frosts if you keep picking them and don't allow them to seed.



We have already dosed my barren vegetable beds with old rotten chicken muck, lots of it, as the weather last year leached all the goodness out of it, so most of my vegetables failed miserably. This year I'm determined the soil will have some richness to it. I hate it when all that hard work goes to waste.

January is planning month, kindling that gardening excitement, looking at seed catalogues, I've already been asked about growing Melons and Pumpkins, a subject I know nothing about. Someone with a newly erected polycrub.

My next task is to put Tomato feed, watered into my fruit trees for a quick burst of (wake up you lot) springs coming! I've already checked all the dormant buds which look healthy and full. Oh the excitement! I can hardly wait for a swelling bud of pink/white blossom. A New Year of growing just around the corner waiting !



Penny Spinks
Hacklete



GENERAL KNOWLEDGE QUIZ - ANSWERS

- | | | |
|------------------|---------------|------------------|
| 1. The Goon Show | 11.Mt Olympus | 21.Stephen King |
| 2. Kaliningrad | 12.Bonxie | 22.Jan & Dean |
| 3. It's self | 13.Victorians | 23.Cain |
| 4. Venus | 14.Hood | 24.Coronation St |
| 5. Superman | 15.Vellum | 25.Cuckoo |
| 6. Suilven | 16.Heather | 26.Columba |
| 7. Aberdeen | 17.Daily Mail | 27.Eiffel Tower |
| 8. 1066 | 18.Cadbury | 28.Hydrogen |
| 9. Macdonald | 19.Vellum | 29.Kate Bush |
| 10.George Orwell | 20.Whiskas | 30.York |

Colin Halliday
Kirkibost



BEATHAICHEAN



O chionn ghoirid cheannaich mi leabhar beag anns a' Bheurla "King of the Roads". Shaoil leam gum biodh e tiodhlac freagarrach do cariad a tha dèidheil air caoraich. Ach nuair a leugh mi e, dh'atharraich mi mo bheachd, oir tha no caoraich anns an sgeulachd glè'olc.

Thug seo m'inntinn giùlan bheathaichean.

Tha mòran bheathaichean fiadhaich cunnurtach, ach tha sin riatanach ma tha iad ag iarraidh mairsinn beò.

Uaireanan bidh peataichean caran fiadhaich cuideachd, a' bìdeadh ne a'sgròbadh achmar as trice th adhbhar math aca sin a dhèanamh.

Agus gun teagamh the beathach taingeil ma chuidicheas tu e.

Dh'fhiosraich mi seo iomadh uair ach tha cuimne agam gu h-àraidh nuair a shàbhail mi seabhag.

Bha mi a' fuireach ann am Pearu aig an àm sin.

Thàinig sgaoth de dh' eòin chun an taighe gach latha far an itheadh iad sìol a thug sinn dhaibh.

Bha a h-uile rud ceart gu leòr gus an do nochd seachag bheag ga tuineachadh fhèin san tùr na h-eaglaise. Theich na h-eòin eile sa bhad.

Aon latha chaidh mi a chuir aodach air an loidhne nuair a chunnaic mi ant-seabhag air a 'bhòrd-obrach, ach bha i na prìosanach le pios uèir air an toinneamh gu teann timcheall aon chas. Bha i a'tarraing agus a' tarraing ach bha e gu dìomhain. Thuirt mi rithe: "Na bìd mi! Bidh mi gad chuideachadh".

Tha mi cinnteach gun do thuig i, oir shìn i a cas am ionnsaigh. Shoar mi an t-seabhag bho chd cho luath 's a b' urrain dhomh. Sheall i orm is an uair sin sgèith i suas dhan tùr agus cha do ghlac an gille i uair eile.

An toiseach rinn mi iomradh air caoraich olc ann an leabhar agus crìochnaichidh mì le sgeulachd fhìor mu coileach aingidh.

Trom leanabas bhiodh mo mhàthair an-còmhnaidh a' gleidheadh ceud cearc. Fhuair iad nuair a bha iad aon latha a dh'aois.

Chaid na bliadhnaich ean seachad agus bha mise fichead mu thrath agus cha robh ach dusan cearcan agus aon choileach againn.

Abhair coileach! Dh'fhàs e na choileach mòr, eireachdail le iteagan cho geal ris an t-sneachd ach nam bheachd fhìn le chrìdhe cho dubh ri gual!

Bha a caomhail is socair ris a h-uile duine, an teaghlach, na nàbhaidhean- clann neo inbhich- i is na coigrich. Ach bha gràin aige orm gu tur!

Cha robh adhbhar sam bith ann, cha robh mise a-riamh air a ghoirteachadh. Bha feagal mo bheatha orm an taigh fhàgail mura robh e anns a' ghàrradh nan cearc.

Gu tric dh'fheuch mi ri thoirt an car às ach lorg e mi an-còmhnaidh agus bha e a' feithamh ris ionnsaigh a thoirt orm.

Bha motheaghlach de'n bheachd gu robh e gu math eibhinn. Bha mi glè thoilichte nuair a reic iad an ciontach mu dheireadh thall.

Linne NicLeòid
Dun Innes



UNUSED COMPUTERS?

Do you have any unused or unwanted technology like laptops, tablets or phones that could use a new home, rather than lying, disused in a drawer? We can collect them, refurbish them and pass them on to community members who may not have access to such items.

Contact the Bernera News Team:

Julia **07894 516 609** | julia@croft22.co.uk or Nat **07831 690 547** | nat@croft22.co.uk

2 FROGS

Our daily lives tend to be so busy. Myraid calls upon our time. Appointments and meetings clamouring with one another, for primacy.

The story is told of two frogs who fell into a tub of cream. Viewing the high sides of the tub which were too difficult to leap up and over one said to the other, "It is hopeless." So he resigned himself to an inevitable death, relaxed, and sank to the bottom. The other one determined to keep swimming as long as he could. "Something might happen," he said. He kept kicking and churning, and finally he found himself on a solid platform of butter and jumped to safety.

What began as a trial of patience became a test of perseverance. A virtue, defined, as a continued effort to do or achieve something, even when this is difficult or takes a long time. And in the case of the frog, a virtue delivering freedom from a gloopy demise.

Illness, family and financial challenge can all present situations requiring perseverance to be deployed. Not to give up. But to keep going. Despite, the challenges, the clouds, the mountains, and valleys of discouragement, disappointment and rejection.

Paul informs and encourages, us to remember that God's grace is uniquely available, to us to, **'bear all things, believe all things, hope all things, endure all things'**

1 Corinthians 13:7

Rev Hugh Maurice Stewart
Uig & Bernera



BERNERA BAKES...

TAGLIARINI WITH MEATBALLS IN RED WINE AND OYSTER MUSHROOM SAUCE

A different twist is given to this traditional pasta dish with a rich, but subtle, sauce.

Ingredients:

150g white breadcrumbs	1 tbsp tomato purée (paste)
150ml milk	1 tsp brown sugar
25g butter	1 tbsp chopped fresh basil
9 tbsp olive oil	12 shallots, chopped
225g sliced oyster mushrooms	450g minced (ground) steak
1 tsp brown sugar	1 tsp paprika
25g wholemeal flour	450g dried egg tagliarini
200ml beef stock	salt and pepper
150ml red wine	fresh basil sprigs, to garnish
4 tomatoes, skinned and chopped	

Method:

1. Soak the breadcrumbs in the milk for 30 minutes.
2. Heat half the butter and 4 tbsp of the oil in a pan. Fry the mushrooms for 4 minutes, then stir in the flour and cook for 2 minutes. Add the stock and wine and simmer for 15 minutes. Add the tomatoes, tomato purée (paste), sugar and basil. Season well and simmer for 30 minutes.
3. Mix the shallots, steak and paprika with the breadcrumbs and season. Shape the mixture into 14 meatballs.
4. Heat 4tbsp of the remaining oil and the remaining butter in a large frying pan. Fry the meatballs, turning frequently, until brown all over. Transfer to a deep casserole, pour over the red wine and the mushroom sauce, cover and bake in a preheated oven at 180°C/350°F/Gas 4 for 30 mins
5. Bring a pan of salted water to the boil. Add the pasta and the remaining oil and cook until tender. Drain and transfer to a serving dish. Remove the casserole from the oven and cool for 3 minutes. Pour the meatballs and sauce on to the pasta, garnish with the basil sprigs and serve.



Careen MacLennan
Kirkibost





With the cost of living Crisis hitting some individuals and families hard, many people are struggling with paying bills or worried about the future. We've included a list of services that are available to offer help, advice and support. If you are experiencing financial difficulty or anxiety, please don't struggle alone, there is support out there.

The **Cost of Living Support Scotland** website offers information on the wide range of advice and financial support available to people in Scotland. <http://gov.scot/costoflivingsupport>

The **MoneyHelper** website offers a range of free, expert tools and guidance to help those struggling with bills, managing irregular earnings or worried about credit. www.moneyhelper.org.uk

StepChange Debt Charity Scotland offers free debt advice, helping people deal with debts and set up a solution. **0800 138 1111** www.stepchange.org

Western Isles Citizen's Advice Bureau offer free and confidential advice on many problems. We have legal, benefit, finance and housing experts. **01851 705727** (Lewis) www.wicas.uk

Hebridean Housing Partnership are a charitable, not-for-profit housing association. **0300 123 0773** www.hebrideanhousing.co.uk

Tighean Innse Gall assists and supports the householder to improve their housing conditions through various grants, insulation measures and energy advice. **01851 706121** (Western Isles) www.tighean.co.uk

The **Jobcentre** can advise on Universal Credit and other benefits, we give information on employment and training opportunities. **01851 743663** Email: stornoway-jobcentre@dwp.gov.uk

Financial Inclusion Service for people who are on low incomes. **01851 822 654** Email: inclusion@cne-siar.gov.uk

The **Benefit Office** administer Housing Benefit which is a means-tested state benefit that helps people who are on low incomes pay their rent. They also administer Council Tax reductions. **01851 822 642** Email: benefits@cne-siar.gov.uk

Scottish Welfare Fund can provide crisis grants to cover the cost of an emergency. **01851 822 642** www.cne-siar.gov.uk/benefitsand-grants/scottish-welfare-fund

HI-Scot Credit Union encourage people to save, and members have financial security through low cost loans. **01851 701865** Email: info@hi-scot.com

Social Security Scotland can advise if you are eligible for support from Social Security Scotland. For example, Scottish Child Payment, Best Start Grant & Best Start Foods can help with the costs of having a child. **0800 182 2222** (freephone) www.mygov.scot/benefit

Home Energy Scotland for free, impartial energy efficiency advice to help save on bills and stay warm at home. **0808 808 2282** www.homeenergyscotland.org

Western Isles Foodbank provides details of where food parcels can be collected from. **01851 706650** (Lewis/Harris) www.cne-siar.gov.uk/news/2020/september/food-bank-contact-details.

Turn2Us for information and support about welfare benefits and charitable grants. **0808 802 2000** <https://benefits-calculator.turn2us.org.uk>

Homelessness Service provides support, if needed, to household assessed as homeless or potentially homeless. **01851 822 821** (Lewis & Harris).

Out of Hours **01851 701 702** www.cne-siar.gov.uk/housing/homelessness

Shelter for free housing advice. **0808 800 4444** www.scotland.shelter.org.uk